

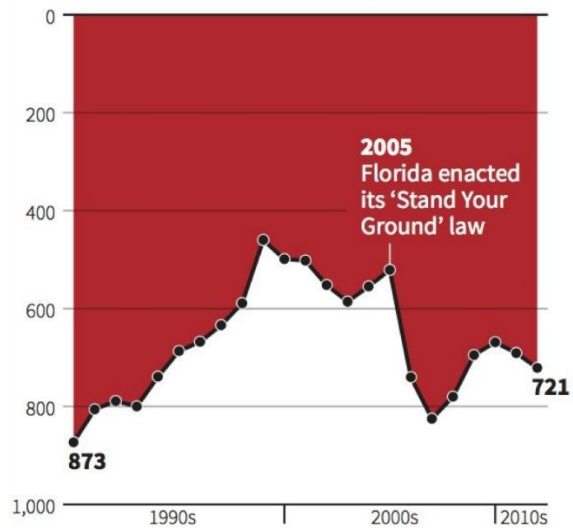
Exercise 4 | Junk charts

(1) wrong charts

① Gun deaths in Florida: Y axis reversed

Gun deaths in Florida

Number of murders committed using firearms



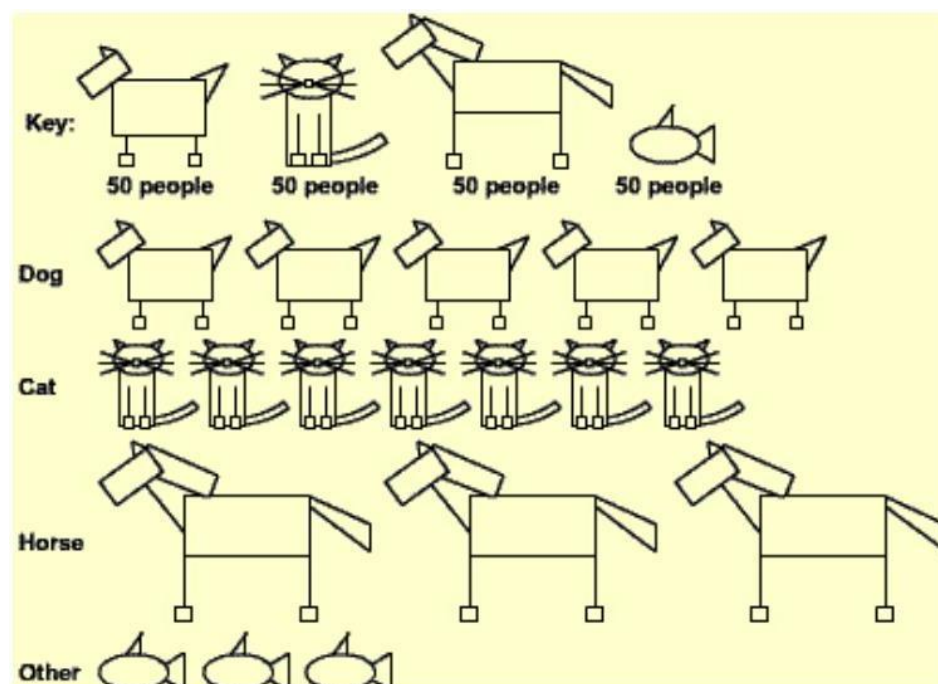
Source: Florida Department of Law Enforcement

C. Chan 16/02/2014

REUTERS

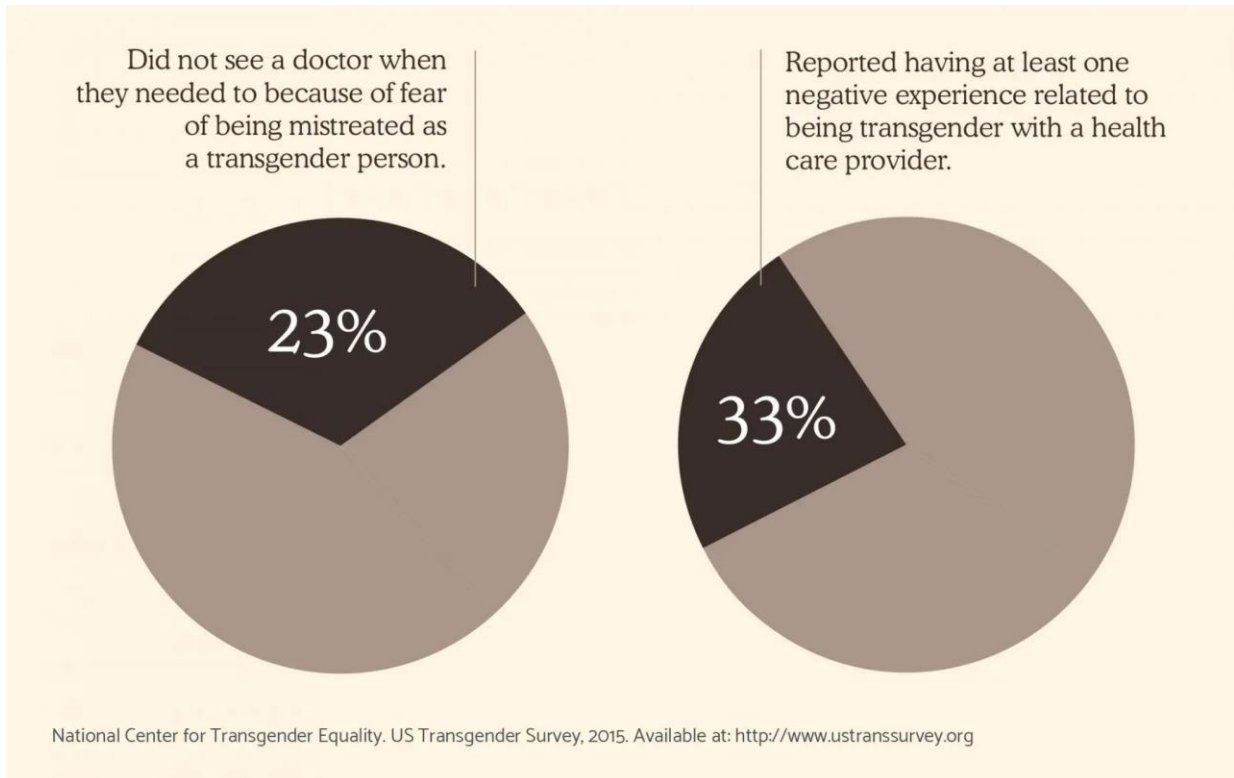
The y-axis is reversed, with zero at the top. Therefore, an increase in gun deaths visually looks like a decrease, which can easily mislead the reader.

② Pet ownership pictogram, Icons have inconsistent sizes



Each symbol is supposed to represent 50 people, but the animal icons have very different sizes. This makes some categories appear more important simply because their icons are larger.

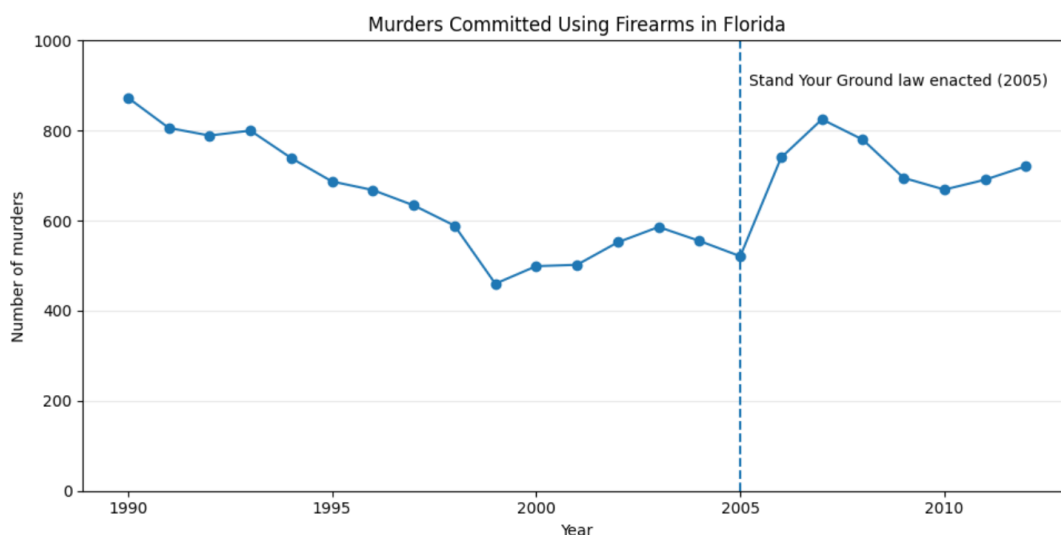
③ The pie charts:



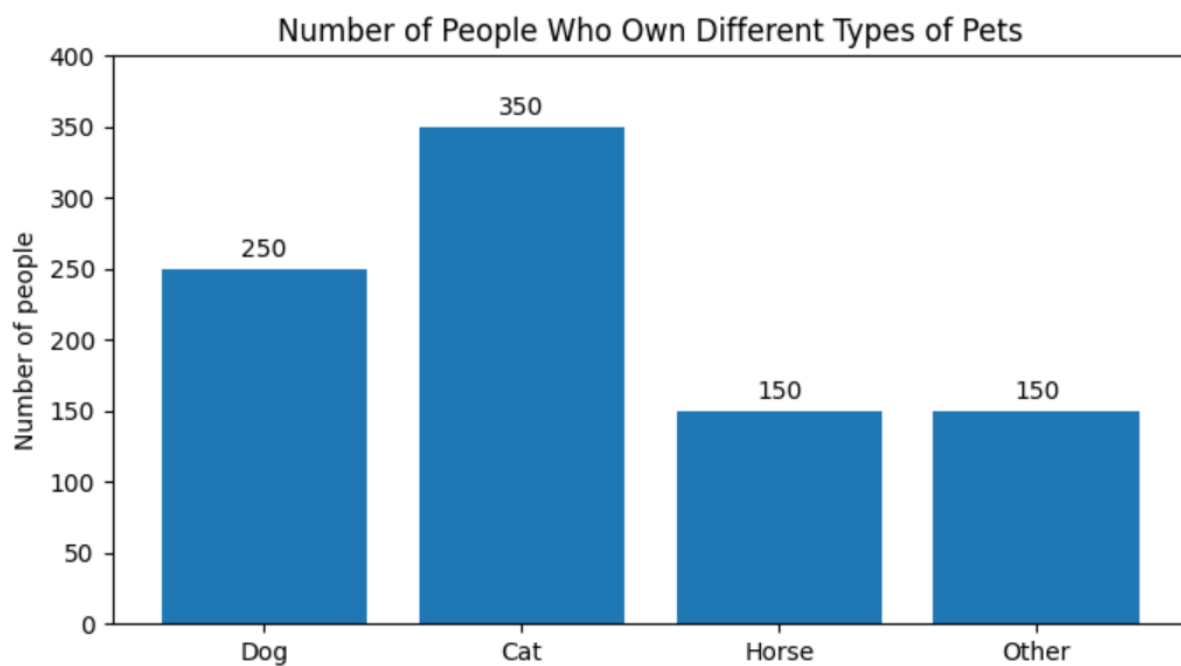
The sizes of the pie slices are not proportional to the percentages shown. The 23% slice even appears larger than the 33% slice, which makes the visualization misleading.

(2) improved versions of the charts

①



②



③

